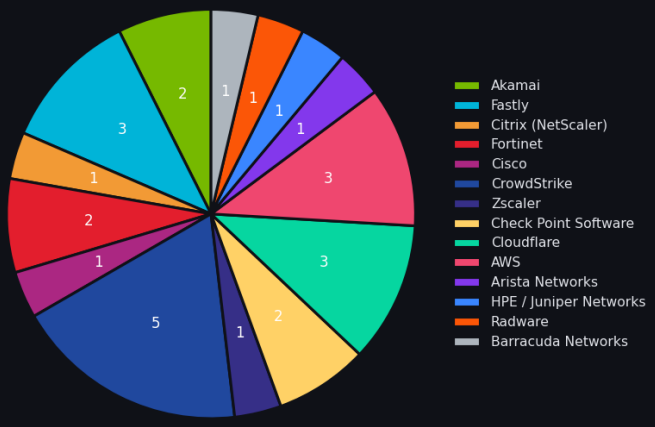
F5 Daily Briefing – Wednesday, November 04, 2026

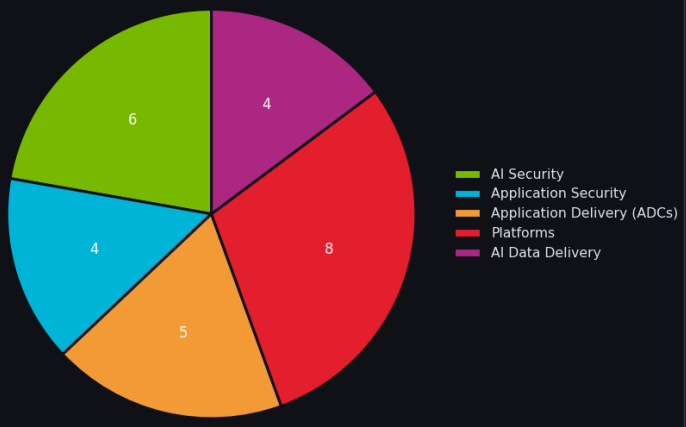
Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22	27	14	5
COMPETITORS TRACKED	ANNOUNCEMENTS	ACTIVE	ACTIVE CATEGORIES

Announcements by Competitor



Announcements by Category



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (27)

Research Akamai Nov 04, 2026

Akamai Research: Synthetic CISOs Call AI Agents the Most Underestimated Risk

Akamai surveyed 1,067 synthetic CISOs. Only 10% report mature security controls for AI agents, compared with 48% for APIs. Top worries are non-human identities with too much access, fraud driven by agents, and runaway agents. The study also found that APIs behind AI apps were the most common target of API attacks. Akamai uses this to tie AI agent risk to its API security story, which competes with F5 AI Guardrails and Distributed Cloud API Security.

Source: https://www.akamai.com/blog/ai/synthetic-cisos-call-ai-agents-most-underestimated-risk

Product Update Akamai Nov 04, 2026

Akamai Enhances Web Security Analytics for App & API Protector

Akamai updated Web Security Analytics. A new panel switches between Edge, Client-Side and App & API Protector Hybrid views. The AI Assistant now says when an insight has expired. The Samples view now groups IP and Geo data to show large DoS events. Fixes restore Botnet IDs and make API operation names searchable. Akamai keeps improving WAAP observability and its hybrid deployment option, which compete with F5 Distributed Cloud WAAP and Advanced WAF analytics.

Source: https://techdocs.akamai.com/security-ctr/changelog/nov-4-2026-improvements-to-web-security-analytics

Financial Fastly Nov 04, 2026

Fastly Reports Record Q3 2026 Revenue of $190.2M, Up 20% Year over Year

Fastly reported record Q3 revenue of $190.2M, up 20% year over year. Security revenue grew 32% to $44.7M, and Network Services grew 16% to $138.0M. Net retention reached 119%, RPO rose 24% to $334M, and 74% of large customers now use two or more product suites. Fastly also highlighted its AI Runtime Control, AI Firewall and API Security products, plus an edge partnership with Comcast. Fast security growth and suite bundling make Fastly a stronger competitor to F5 in edge app delivery and security deals.

Source: https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20261104512325/en/Fastly-Announces-Third-Quarter-2026-Financial-Results

Leadership Fastly Nov 04, 2026

Fastly Go-To-Market President Scott Lovett to Retire; CRO Search Begins

Fastly said Scott Lovett, President of Go-To-Market, plans to retire in 2027. The company is starting a search for a Chief Revenue Officer, and Lovett will lead sales through the handover before becoming a Senior Advisor. Shares fell more than 15% after hours alongside the Q3 results. A change at the top of Fastly's sales team could slow its large-account growth, which gives F5 field teams an opening at Fastly accounts that are up for renewal or expansion.

Source: https://seekingalpha.com/news/4665086-fastly-free-falls-after-q3-earnings-go-to-market-head-lovett-retiring

Partnership Fastly Nov 04, 2026

Fastly and Jio Platforms Expand Alliance to Offer JioCDN to Indian Enterprises

Fastly and Jio Platforms expanded their partnership on JioCDN, a CDN that runs Fastly's edge technology on Jio's network. After large-scale testing, the service is now available to Indian companies and institutions in e-commerce, digital banking, the public sector and media. The deal gives Fastly carrier-scale reach in India, adding to its Comcast partnership in the US. That raises the competition F5 faces for edge delivery and security work with service providers and large enterprises in APAC.

Source: https://www.computing.es/noticias/fastly-y-jio-platforms-amplian-su-alianza-estrategica-para-impulsar-la-red-de-distribucion-de-contenidos-jiocdn/

Product Launch Citrix (NetScaler) Nov 04, 2026

Citrix Adds AI Agent Governance, Agentic Workspaces and Platform Credits

Citrix expanded SecurSpaces to run AI agents in a centrally governed workspace, and these updates are available now. SecurAccess gets three governance features by month-end: detection of autonomous browsing activity, limits on what agents can do via Model Context Protocol (MCP), and AI-governed session insights. Citrix also launched consumption-based Platform Credits and a free SecurSpaces Community Edition. This is workspace and access governance rather than a NetScaler update. Even so, Citrix is now pitching MCP-based agent controls, which overlaps with F5's AI Guardrails and AI gateway messaging.

Source: https://www.citrix.com/news/announcements/nov-2026/citrix-advances-secure-ai-adoption.html

Event Fortinet Nov 04, 2026

Fortinet Hosts Virtual Security Operations Summit Focused on AI-Native SecOps

Fortinet opened a two-day virtual Security Operations Summit on November 4–5. It focused on AI-native threat detection, investigation and response using agentic AI across the Fortinet Security Fabric and FortiAIGate. Fortinet executives, IDC and FortiGuard Labs presented, along with customer H-E Parts International. The event shows Fortinet turning its AI message into platform-wide SOC use cases after its Q3 results. Expect platform-consolidation arguments in deals where F5 positions best-of-breed app and AI security.

Source: https://www.ad-hoc-news.de/boerse/news/corporate-news/fortinet-stock-enters-ai-summit-focused-on-ai-native-security/70457867

Product Launch Fortinet Nov 04, 2026

Fortinet Launches FortiGuard Inline AI Security Service for FortiGate, Expands FortiAIGate

Fortinet added cloud-delivered AI guardrails to existing FortiGate firewalls. The service inspects prompts, model calls, MCP tool calls, API activity and agent actions. It also includes DLP that finds more than 35 types of PII and confidential data, model and spend controls with Denial-of-Wallet protection, and shadow AI visibility. Customers can self-host FortiAIGate on NVIDIA GPU Kubernetes for data sovereignty, and its guardrails use technology from Fortinet's Virtue AI acquisition. Fortinet is bundling AI runtime security into firewalls customers already own, which puts direct pressure on F5 AI Guardrails and AI Gateway deals.

Source: https://www.appsgadget.com/2026/11/fortinet-fortiguard-inline-ai-security-service-fortaigate.html

Product Launch Cisco Nov 04, 2026

Cisco Introduces Privileged Infrastructure Access for People and AI Agents

Cisco introduced Privileged Infrastructure Access, a just-in-time permission model for administrators, delegated AI agents and automation scripts. It uses cryptographic identity, privileges that expire when the task ends, and session recording, built on existing ISE and TACACS+ policies. Coverage extends to routers, switches, servers, Kubernetes and cloud resources. Cisco is building agent identity and access controls into infrastructure operations, which widens its agentic AI security story against F5's AI security and agent-governance positioning.

Source: https://thejournal.com/articles/2026/11/04/cisco-intros-privileged-infrastructure-access-for-people-and-ai-agents.aspx

Product Launch CrowdStrike Nov 04, 2026

CrowdStrike Unveils Agentic Adversary Emulation on the Falcon Platform

CrowdStrike launched Agentic Adversary Emulation, powered by SafeMind. Its Red Tempest AI acts as an autonomous attacker that chains vulnerabilities, misconfigurations, and identity gaps into exploitable attack paths. The tool then drives remediation and re-tests to confirm each path is closed. It is in early access through Project QuiltWorks partners. The launch adds continuous, AI-driven exposure validation to the Falcon platform, strengthening CrowdStrike's case for consolidating onto one platform.

Source: https://ir.crowdstrike.com/news-releases/news-release-details/crowdstrike-unveils-agentic-adversary-emulation-falcon-platform/

Product Launch CrowdStrike Nov 04, 2026

CrowdStrike Brings Falcon Seraphic Enterprise Browser Security Natively to the Falcon Platform

Falcon Seraphic Enterprise Browser is now native to Falcon. It protects sessions in the browsers people already use, on managed and unmanaged devices, with no separate browser and no traffic rerouting. It enforces data and AI-usage policies, manages extensions, and provides secure access to private applications for BYOD users and contractors. This puts CrowdStrike into secure remote access, which overlaps with F5 BIG-IP APM and Distributed Cloud secure access use cases.

Source: https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/blog/crowdstrike-brings-enterprise-browser-security-to-falcon-platform/

Product Update CrowdStrike Nov 04, 2026

New Falcon Cloud Security Innovations Secure the Cloud AI Runs On

CrowdStrike extended Real-Time Cloud Detection and Response to Microsoft Azure and Kubernetes, alongside AWS and Google Cloud. It also added cloud IOAs (indicators of attack) with posture context and AI anomaly detection that spots API misuse and account takeover in AWS CloudTrail. The update unifies supply chain, posture, and runtime protection from build to runtime. CrowdStrike is now pitching protection for the cloud and API layer under AI workloads, an area where F5 Distributed Cloud API security and multicloud delivery compete.

Source: https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/blog/falcon-cloud-security-innovations-secure-cloud-ai-runs-on/

Product Launch CrowdStrike Nov 04, 2026

CrowdStrike Launches Sovereign Cloud in Saudi Arabia

CrowdStrike launched an in-country sovereign cloud in Saudi Arabia, available now. It runs Falcon workloads, telemetry, and management locally to meet Saudi regulations while still drawing on global threat intelligence and AI agent security, and it highlights work with Aramco. Sovereign AI deployments are a growing pursuit for platform vendors. F5 field and cloud alliance teams in the Middle East should be ready to show F5 sovereign and on-premises deployment options.

Source: https://ir.crowdstrike.com/news-releases/news-release-details/crowdstrike-launches-sovereign-cloud-saudi-arabia-bringing-ai/

Product Launch CrowdStrike Nov 04, 2026

CrowdStrike Extends the Agentic SOC to Detect and Stop the Agent Insider Threat, Adds AI Kill Switch

CrowdStrike introduced Agent Insider Threat Detection (Q4). It learns the normal behavior of each AI agent and its owner and flags deviations through Falcon Next-Gen SIEM. Multi-agent investigations are now generally available, and the Falcon Guardian AI Kill Switch can stop rogue agents at the gateway and cut off their network access. CrowdStrike is presenting agentic AI governance as a SOC feature, which overlaps with F5's runtime AI security and AI gateway messaging. Sellers should expect agent-containment questions.

Source: https://ir.crowdstrike.com/news-releases/news-release-details/crowdstrike-extends-agentic-soc-detect-and-stop-agent-insider/

Product Launch Zscaler Nov 04, 2026

Zscaler Adds Thick-Client Application Isolation to Zero Trust Browser as a VDI Alternative

Zscaler announced Application Isolation in its Zero Trust Browser. Thick-client apps such as SAP GUI, IDEs, and database tools run in isolated cloud environments, rendered in the browser, with no endpoint agent or VDI client. Traffic goes through ZIA and ZPA, and browser data protection controls such as clipboard and file-transfer limits and watermarking apply to these sessions. Zscaler is pitching this as a VDI replacement, which pressures F5 BIG-IP APM and Citrix-adjacent secure access and app delivery deals.

Source: https://insidecybersec.com/zscaler-adds-thick-client-app-delivery-to-zero-trust-browser/

Financial Check Point Software Nov 04, 2026

Check Point Shares Drop ~12% as Q3 2026 Results Signal Slower Recovery

Check Point shares fell about 12% in premarket trading after Q3 revenue of about $670M (down ~1% year over year) slightly missed estimates. Legacy product sales fell about 19%, and the CEO said the product recovery will be slower than expected, starting in Q4 2026. The weak firewall refresh and the shift toward cloud and AI security create openings for F5 in security consolidation deals with customers who are re-evaluating Check Point.

Source: https://www.jpost.com/business-and-innovation/tech-and-start-ups/article-913787

Research Check Point Software Nov 04, 2026

Check Point Research: HYFLOCK Ransomware Evolves with New Builds and Encryption Weaknesses

Check Point Research reports that HYFLOCK ransomware went through four generations in six months, with October 2026 builds changing how it deploys and runs. Researchers also found encryption flaws that allowed partial file recovery without a decryption key. This research supports Check Point's threat intelligence pitch. F5 marketing can use it as context for ransomware and defense-in-depth messaging.

Source: https://blog.checkpoint.com/security/hyflock-ransomware-evolves-with-new-builds-and-encryption-weaknesses/

Product Update Cloudflare Nov 04, 2026

Cloudflare AI Gateway Adds Model Aliases for Pooled Routing and Fallback

Cloudflare AI Gateway now supports model aliases. One name, such as custom/support-fast, points to a pool of models. The gateway tries the models in a set order, falls back when one fails, and can route each request intelligently. Teams can swap models or change routing without redeploying. This strengthens Cloudflare's AI gateway as a traffic-management layer for AI and competes directly with F5's AI Gateway and AI Data Delivery story on routing and resilience across many models.

Source: https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-11-04-model-aliases/

Product Update Cloudflare Nov 04, 2026

Cloudflare Private Load Balancers Gain Session Affinity and Hash Steering

Cloudflare private load balancers can now keep Cloudflare One users and private-network traffic on the same endpoint. They do this with hash endpoint steering or ip_cookie session affinity, which suits apps that keep session state on the server. Cloudflare One Client users are identified by device, so they stay on the same endpoint even if their IP address changes. These are classic ADC persistence features delivered inside Cloudflare's SASE platform, and they challenge BIG-IP LTM for private and internal app delivery.

Source: https://developers.cloudflare.com/changelog/post/2026-11-04-private-lb-session-affinity/

Product Update Cloudflare Nov 04, 2026

Cloudflare Adds Personal Agent Analytics and Per-Agent Access Policies

Cloudflare added a Personal Assistants category to Security Analytics. It shows which AI agents visit a site, how many requests they send, and which paths, logins and errors they touch. Site owners can now set a separate policy for each agent: Allow, Block on pages with ads, or Block. This takes Cloudflare's bot management into control of agentic traffic, which overlaps with F5 Distributed Cloud Bot Defense. F5 should be ready to explain how it tells agents apart and applies policy to each one.

Source: https://blog.cloudflare.com/personal-agents-visibility-control/

Product Update AWS Nov 04, 2026

Bedrock AgentCore Gateway Adds On-Behalf-Of Identity Pattern with ServiceNow

AWS described an on-behalf-of token exchange in Bedrock AgentCore Gateway. An agent signs in with a Microsoft Entra ID token, and the gateway swaps it for a token scoped to a ServiceNow connector. Agents then act as the signed-in user, with that user's permissions and an audit trail, and no custom code is needed. This puts identity and authorization for agents inside AWS's own gateway. F5 should stress authorization for agent and MCP traffic that works across clouds.

Source: https://securitynews.com/business-perspectives/aws-bedrock-integrates-with-servicenow-for-secure-ai-identity/

Partnership AWS Nov 04, 2026

OpenAI Daybreak Red and GPT-5.6 Cyber Available in AWS GovCloud via Bedrock

OpenAI's Daybreak Red and GPT-5.6 Cyber are now available to approved government customers in AWS GovCloud (US-East) through Amazon Bedrock. They support vulnerability research, exploit validation and defensive workflows, with strict identity checks, and inference data is not used for training. Bedrock keeps growing as the channel for frontier-model inference in the US public sector. F5 public-sector teams should position AI security and traffic controls around Bedrock-hosted model use.

Source: https://openai.com/index/daybreak-red-aws-govcloud

Partnership AWS Nov 04, 2026

AWS Interconnect – Last Mile Preview with Equinix

AWS released a preview of AWS Interconnect – last mile with Equinix. It gives private, managed connections from Equinix Fabric One to AWS, with four redundant links, MACsec encryption on by default and a 99.99% SLA. The preview offers free 1 Gbps links in N. California and N. Virginia, and general availability will scale to 100 Gbps. Hybrid connectivity is getting easier, so F5 alliance and services teams should position F5 traffic management and security across these AWS–Equinix paths.

Source: https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/11/interconnect-last-mile-preview-equinix/

Financial Arista Networks Nov 04, 2026

Arista's Record Q3 2026: $3.66B Revenue, Up 58.5%, as the Network Becomes Central to AI

Arista reported Q3 revenue of $3.66B, up 58.5% year over year, with a 49.1% non-GAAP operating margin. It guided Q4 to $3.9–$4.0B, raised full-year 2026 to about $13.3B, and expects 2027 to reach about $18.5B. CEO Jayshree Ullal says AI is moving from compute-centric to network-centric, with inference spread across different accelerators and over 100 Etherlink AI customers. Arista's pitch of multi-vendor AI fabrics is getting stronger in the same AI factory accounts where F5 sells AI traffic management and inference delivery. F5 should position the application and inference layer above Arista's fabric.

Source: https://siliconangle.com/2026/11/04/aristas-record-quarter-shows-the-network-has-become-central-to-ai/

Product Launch HPE / Juniper Networks Nov 04, 2026

HPE Launches Four ProLiant Gen13 Servers for Enterprise AI Inference and Agentic Workloads

HPE announced four ProLiant Gen13 servers (DL525, DL585a, XD245, XD285) with 6th-gen AMD EPYC processors. They are built for AI inference, analytics, simulation and agentic AI. Security features include self-encrypting drives, automated key management through iLO 8, multi-person approvals and post-quantum cryptography. The DL525 ships in late 2026 and the others in 2027. HPE is growing its full-stack on-prem AI infrastructure offer, which it pairs with Juniper networking. That could pull inference delivery and security decisions into HPE-led bundles. F5 sellers and alliances should push F5 for AI traffic management and protection on HPE-based AI factories.

Source: https://www.ad-hoc-news.de/boerse/news/corporate-news/hewlett-packard-enterprise-aktie-hpe-setzt-auf-gen13-fuer-ki-lasten/70456400

Research Radware Nov 04, 2026

Radware Details How Bot Manager Detects Anti-Detect Browser Automation Frameworks

A Radware research blog post says attackers now combine AI-driven agents, residential proxies, CAPTCHA-solving services and anti-detect frameworks to make bot traffic look human. Radware describes a two-layer defense in Bot Manager: hard signatures for known tools, plus client-side composite scoring based on behavioral signals. It argues that judging behavior and intent beats static fingerprinting. This is a direct bot-defense thought-leadership play against F5 Distributed Cloud Bot Defense. F5 PMM and marketing should refresh F5's content on AI-agent and anti-detect bot evasion.

Source: https://www.radware.com/blog/anti-detect-browser-automation-frameworks/

Research Barracuda Networks Nov 04, 2026

Barracuda Research: Future MSP Growth Will Be Driven by AI Expertise and Cyber Resilience

Barracuda released a survey of 2,000 IT and security decision makers, conducted by Arlington Research. It found 66% of organizations already use an MSP and 29% more are evaluating one. 59% worry about AI-enabled threats such as AI phishing and shadow AI. Only 29% of organizations seeking MSP support can secure compromised accounts and restore operations within hours. Barracuda is building its MSP channel story around AI security and resilience. F5 channel and alliance teams should use this as a benchmark for MSP and MSSP messaging on F5 AI security and app protection services.

Source: https://www.businesswire.com/news/home/20261104572040/en/Barracuda-Research-Survey-Future-MSP-Growth-Will-Be-Driven-by-AI-Expertise-and-Cyber-Resilience